

INF632 Research Project

Build your Own Wearable / Analysis of Commodity Wearable Data

1 Literature Review

Assigned: February 10.

Due: February 24 at 11:59pm. Submissions turned in after this time and still within two weeks of this deadline will be automatically docked 50% of the possible points.

Submission: Share a direct link to your repo / folder on canvas.nau.edu by the deadline.

Points: EE499 students, this is worth 5% of your final grade. EE599 students, this is worth 10% of your final grade.

Background:

Science is fundamentally rooted in the ongoing pursuit of knowledge, which is reflected in the existing literature. A thorough understanding of this body of work is essential for identifying gaps and formulating the pertinent questions that should be explored next. To effectively chart a course for further research, one must engage deeply with what has already been accomplished in the field. Failing to do so may lead to redundant efforts, essentially reiterating the findings of previous studies rather than contributing new insights. By critically analyzing existing literature, researchers can ensure that their work builds upon established knowledge, drives innovation, and addresses unanswered questions in the scientific community.

Assignment:

This is the first of five assignments related to your class project. In this assignment, you need to identify papers related to your desired project. These should provide background and motivation for what you want to do within your project. Up to two can directly reflect what you want to do (for a class project, it is okay to repeat the work of others).

At least three citations must be discussed in detail; others can be “lightly” reviewed. Write a summary of the “current state of the art” related to your research project. See the papers we have discussed and the “extras” to get a good feeling for what this section should look like. Make sure that you are clearly motivating the direction for your project from the literature you review.

Expectations and Grading Rubric:

I expect your literature review to be complete, on the order of three to twelve paragraphs. Your submission must use the IEEE JBHI Template (Grad must use L^AT_EX, Undergrad may use the L^AT_EX or Word template).

On the topic of ethics, be sure that you have properly cited everything and have not plagiarized anyone’s work in your paper. You may use a generative AI to help you revise paragraphs or to help with detailed guidance, but do NOT use it to write your paper. You’re here to learn - please go through the process of learning!

Your submission will be graded as follows:

Area	Frac. of Points	UG: Meets Expectations	UG:Exceeds, G:Meets Expectations	G:Exceeds Expectations
Scope	20%	Some focus; misses key aspects or topics.	Mostly focused, addresses most key aspects.	Focused and addresses all key aspects.
Sources	20%	Uses some relevant sources; limited variety. 3-5 total.	Uses mostly high-quality and relevant sources. 5-7 total.	Uses diverse, high-quality, and relevant sources. 9 or more.
Format	10%	Some structure, but lacks coherence; unclear transitions.	Generally structured; some unclear transitions.	Well-structured with clear headings and transitions.
Critical Analysis	20%	Basic analysis; limited synthesis of insights.	Good analysis; some synthesis of insights.	In-depth critical analysis and synthesis of literature.
Reflection	15%	Limited reflection; few future research gaps identified.	Some reflection; identifies some future research gaps.	Meaningful reflection; identifies future research gaps.
Writing Quality	15%	Some clarity issues; several errors affect readability.	Mostly clear writing; few errors.	Clear, concise, and error-free writing.

2 Questions and Hypotheses

Assigned: February 24.

Due: March 3 at 11:59pm. Submissions turned in after this time and still within two weeks of this deadline, will be automatically docked 50% of the possible points.

Submission: Share a direct link to your repo / folder on canvas.nau.edu by the deadline.

Points: EE499 students, this is worth 10% of your final grade. EE599 students, this is worth 10% of your final grade.

Background:

Writing compelling research questions and hypotheses is a crucial step in the scientific inquiry process. These elements serve as the foundation for guiding investigations and shaping the direction of research. A well-crafted research question not only delineates the scope of the study but also establishes its relevance and significance within the broader context of the field. Formulating testable hypotheses provides a framework for empirical investigation, allowing researchers to make predictions that can be systematically examined. Together, thoughtful questions and hypotheses drive the research process, encouraging rigorous analysis and critical thinking. They also enable a clear articulation of the research objectives, fostering a deeper understanding of the underlying issues and facilitating discussions that may lead to transformative insights. In summary, skillfully articulating questions and hypotheses is essential for advancing knowledge and ensuring meaningful contributions to the scientific community.

Assignment:

This is the second of the assignments related to your class project. In this assignment, you need to identify your hypotheses, aims, or objectives of your project. This is the “what” question or goal. You will need to develop, in one to three sentences, your primary hypothesis. This should be phrased in a testable format. Follow your hypothesis with expected and alternative results. Then identify at least two more secondary hypotheses, also outlining these like the first. Finally, explain how your project will allow you to investigate this question.

Note, this should be motivated by your literature review.

For example:

Hypo: Community gait is statistically significantly more variable than gait observed in the controlled setting of a lab.

Exp: The data collected in the community setting through normal daily wear will show a higher degree of variability than that which we collect from a 10m walk test and timed up and go test in the lab setting.

Alt: Though unanticipated, we may find that the clinical tests reflect a measure of variability also found in the community measures.

Interp: By developing a wearable goniometer, we will be able to assess the variability of normal gait in the community and clinical settings.

Expectations and Grading Rubric:

This section will probably be fairly small, a few paragraphs at most. That is okay. This might be three to six paragraphs. I want you to focus on clearly articulating your objectives to me.

Your submission must use the IEEE JBHI Template (Grad must use L^AT_EX, Undergrad may use the L^AT_EX or Word template) and must include your previous section, hopefully revised. In addition to the expectations for your objectives, I will be grading your previous section. You should have feedback from the previous section, which should be integrated into that section, and will be graded as part of the overall writing quality of your work.

Area	Frac. of Points	UG: Meets Expectations	UG:Exceeds, G:Meets Expectations	G:Exceeds Expectations
Clarity of Questions	20%	Some questions are vague or poorly defined.	Questions are mostly clear and specific, with minor ambiguities.	Questions are clear, specific, and well-defined.
Relevance	20%	Some questions are relevant, while others are not.	Questions are generally relevant but may lack depth in relevance.	Questions are highly relevant to the research topic and field.
Testability of Hypotheses	20%	Some hypotheses are testable, but others lack clarity.	Hypotheses are mostly clear and testable, with minor issues.	Hypotheses are clear, testable, and grounded in existing literature.
Alignment of Qs to Hs	20%	Some alignment exists, but connections are weak or unclear.	Good alignment, but some hypotheses may not directly address the questions.	Strong alignment; hypotheses effectively respond to research questions.
Writing Quality	20%	Some clarity issues; several errors affect readability.	Mostly clear writing; few errors.	Clear, concise, and error-free writing.

3 Device Design and Implementation

Assigned: March 3

Due: March 24 at 11:59pm. Submissions turned in after this time and still within two weeks of this deadline will be automatically docked 50% of the possible points.

Submission: Share a direct link to your repo / folder on canvas.nau.edu by the deadline.

Points: EE499 students, this is worth 5% of your final grade. EE599 students, this is worth 10% of your final grade.

Background:

Device design and implementation encompass a critical phase in the development of innovative technologies, involving a meticulous blend of engineering principles, user-centered design, and practical application. This process begins with the identification of user needs and requirements, ensuring that the device effectively addresses real-world problems. Through iterative prototyping and testing, designers refine functional specifications, enhance usability, and optimize performance. The implementation phase translates these designs into functional products, involving the selection of appropriate materials, components, and manufacturing techniques. Effective collaboration across disciplines—such as electronics, software development, and ergonomic design—plays a vital role in creating devices that are not only functional but also intuitive and aesthetically pleasing. Ultimately, a successful design and implementation strategy results in devices that improve user experience, meet market demands, and advance technological innovation, significantly impacting various fields and industries.

Assignment:

This is the third of the assignments related to your class project, and is predominately for your benefit. In this assignment, you need to sketch out (either with paper and pen/pencil, or in your favorite illustrating or schematic program) the wiring layout of your project. For example, how will your OpenLog connect to your Arduino? You'll need to at least have a TX-RX from the Arduino to the OpenLog, and then of course power and ground. Exactly what pin on the Arduino will be used for the TX? There is a default TX pin, but would it benefit you to use a software defined serial port to move the TX to another pin? By drawing everything out, this will give you the chance to identify what aspects require more thought.

Most of you will have a few components linked together without the need for a voltage divider or switches. If you need those (i.e.: you are using a force sensitive resistor), let's talk.

Submit this homework as a digital file please, even if you are drawing out the schematic by hand.

This also means that you can sketch out the schematic on a dry erase board and snap a picture!

Expectations and Grading Rubric:

This section should also be short, and should lean on a schematic or a workflow diagram. The written aspects of this section should support that schematic or workflow diagram.

Area	Frac. of Points	UG: Meets Expectations	UG:Exceeds, G:Meets Expectations	G:Exceeds Expectations
Schematic / Workflow Quality	30%	Basic schematic/workflow; lacks detail or clarity in representation.	Good schematic/workflow; mostly accurate but may be less detailed.	Highly detailed and accurate schematic/workflow that clearly represents design and process.
Clarity of Description	30%	Some description, but lacks key details regarding design or purpose.	Generally clear description with minor ambiguities; covers most aspects.	Detailed and clear description of device design, including purpose and functionality.
Justification of Choices	20%	Limited explanation of design choices; few, if any, references.	Good justification of most design choices; some references to literature.	Comprehensive explanation of design choices, supported by relevant literature or examples.
Writing Quality	20%	Some clarity issues; several errors affect readability.	Mostly clear writing; few errors.	Clear, concise, and error-free writing.

4 Methods Plan

Assigned: March 24.

Due: March 31 at 11:59pm. Submissions turned in after this time and still within two weeks of this deadline will be automatically docked 50% of the possible points.

Submission: Share a direct link to your repo / folder on canvas.nau.edu by the deadline.

Points: EE499 students, this is worth 5% of your final grade. EE599 students, this is worth 5% of your final grade.

Background:

Writing a methods plan is a crucial step in the research process, as it outlines the systematic approach that will be taken to investigate a specific research question or hypothesis. A well-structured methods plan details the research design, including the selection of participants, data collection techniques, and analytical strategies, ensuring that the study is both feasible and scientifically sound. By clearly defining procedures for data collection and analysis, the methods plan serves as a road map, guiding researchers through the execution of the study and facilitating repeatability. It also addresses potential ethical considerations, including the treatment of participants and data integrity. Furthermore, a comprehensive methods plan allows researchers to anticipate challenges and develop contingency measures, ultimately enhancing the reliability and validity of the study findings. In essence, an effective methods plan lays the groundwork for a robust research project, ensuring rigorous execution and meaningful contributions to the field.

Assignment:

Following our discussion in class, you will need to formulate a well defined set of methods, or a standard operating procedure (SOP). Your project need only have one subject (if collecting human data), but consider how you would collect consistent and well controlled data if you were collecting on fifty subjects? Once you have your data, you'll want to perform some analyses that seek to address your core hypothesis (RP 2). For this assignment then, you will need to write up a several paragraph description of your methods for both collecting data, and expected methods of data analysis (yes, you should expect it will change some once you get to performing the analysis). Each core measure or step should have it's own paragraph. Do not write a paragraph on each variable that your wearable will be measuring though (i.e.: x, y, z acceleration). Consider the papers we have read in class, such as that shown here. Following the RP2 example of gait in the community and clinical setting, you would want paragraphs on:

clinical gait: What are the 10m walk and timed up an go tests and how will the subject be instructed to perform them?

community gait: How long will it be worn and what activities will be done?

your wearable: What measures will it collect, and at what sample rate?

analysis: How will the data from each be summarized and then compared?

Expectations and Grading Rubric:

This section should detail nearly everything related to your data collection and analysis. That doesn't mean that things won't change, but this does mean I want to see a very detailed plan!

Area	Frac. of Points	UG: Meets Expectations	UG:Exceeds, G:Meets Expectations	G:Exceeds Expectations
Clarity of Methodology	20%	Some clarity issues; lacks certain details about methods.	Generally clear presentation; minor ambiguities present.	Clear, detailed, and logical presentation of methods used in the research.
Repeatability	10%	Limited detail; key aspects may hinder repeatability.	Most methods are described adequately for replication, but some details are missing.	Methods are described in sufficient detail to allow replication by others.
Justification of Methods	10%	Limited justification; few references to literature ¹ .	Good justification for most methods; some literature support ² .	Strong justification for chosen methods, supported by relevant literature ³ .
Data Collection and Analysis	10%	Basic description; some misalignment with research questions.	Good description; general alignment with research questions.	Detailed description of data collection and analysis techniques; aligns with research questions.
Writing Quality	10%	Some clarity issues; several errors affect readability.	Mostly clear writing; few errors.	Clear, concise, and error-free writing.

5 Analysis

Assigned: March 31.

Due: April 14 at 11:59pm. Submissions turned in after this time and still within two weeks of this deadline will be automatically docked 50% of the possible points.

Submission: Share a direct link to your repo / folder on canvas.nau.edu by the deadline.

Points: EE499 students, this is worth 5% of your final grade. EE599 students, this is worth 10% of your final grade.

Background:

The analysis section of a research project is pivotal, as it transforms raw data into actionable insights that inform conclusions and guide future research. This section involves a systematic examination of the collected data, employing appropriate statistical or qualitative methods to identify patterns, trends, and relationships. By clearly articulating the analytical techniques used—such as regression analysis, thematic analysis, or computational modeling—researchers establish transparency and rigor in their findings. This not only bolsters the credibility of the research but also allows readers to understand the underlying processes that led to the conclusions. Additionally, the analysis section should thoughtfully interpret the results, discussing their implications in the context of existing literature and acknowledging any limitations. By situating findings within a broader framework, researchers can highlight their contributions to the field and suggest avenues for future inquiry. Ultimately, a robust analysis section ensures that data is not merely presented but critically examined, facilitating a deeper understanding of the research question and its significance.

Assignment:

In this assignment you will perform all necessary statistical analyses needed to elucidate the story of your wearable.

Expectations and Grading Rubric:

This section requires analysis code as well. That should not be typeset or dropped into your document, with few exceptions. If you want to include some small segment of code to support some very important statement or detail, that is acceptable.

Area		Frac. of Points	UG: Meets Expectations	UG:Exceeds, G:Meets Expectations	G:Exceeds Expectations
Clarity of Analysis		20%	Some clarity issues; lacks logical flow in parts of the analysis.	Mostly clear; some minor ambiguities present.	Clear and coherent presentation of analysis; logical flow of ideas.
Depth of Analysis		10%	Basic analysis; superficial exploration of data patterns.	Good analysis with some depth, but misses key insights.	In-depth analysis that thoroughly explores the data, highlighting key patterns and insights.
Interpretation of Findings		10%	Basic interpretation; limited connection to research questions.	Generally sound interpretation; some connections may be unclear.	Insightful interpretation that connects findings to research questions and broader context.
Consideration of Limitations		10%	Some mention of limitations; lacks detail and depth.	Generally addresses limitations, but lacks depth.	Thoughtful discussion of limitations and potential impact on findings.
Writing Quality		10%	Some clarity issues; several errors affect readability.	Mostly clear writing; few errors.	Clear, concise, and error-free writing.
Code Comment Quality		15%	Limited comments, making it non-obvious what you did or why.	Comments explain major sections.	Meaningful comments that detail major sections, any challenges that were addressed, and specifics in more complex code blocks.

6 Discussion of Findings

Assigned: April 14.

Due: April 21 at 11:59pm. Submissions turned in after this time and still within two weeks of this deadline will be automatically docked 50% of the possible points.

Submission: First, send me an invite to see your repository (GitHub or Google Drive). Second, share a direct link to your repo / folder on canvas.nau.edu by the deadline.

Points: EE499 students, this is worth 10% of your final grade. EE599 students, this is worth 10% of your final grade.

Background:

The discussion of findings is a vital component of any research project, serving as the bridge between the data collected and its broader implications within the field. In this section, researchers interpret their results, contextualizing them within the framework of existing literature and theoretical perspectives. This involves critically analyzing how the findings align or contrast with prior studies, offering insights into their significance and relevance. Furthermore, the discussion should address the practical implications of the results, exploring how they can inform practice, policy, or further research. Importantly, this section also considers the limitations of the study, acknowledging potential biases, methodological constraints, and areas for future exploration. By fostering a nuanced dialogue around the findings, the discussion not only enhances the understanding of the research question but also paves the way for future inquiry, encouraging ongoing investigation and contributing to the advancement of knowledge in the field.

Assignment:

Write a short, a few paragraphs at most, discussion and findings section as part of the paper that you are building. This should do more than just summarize what you have done, as it should provide the interpretations of your findings. As we talked about in class, all of your claims should be supported by your results.

Expectations and Grading Rubric:

Revise previous sections. Add the discussion or conclusion to your paper. This should finish off the written report!

Your submission will be graded as follows:

Area	Frac. of Points	UG: Meets Expectations	UG:Exceeds, G:Meets Expectations	G:Exceeds Expectations
Clarity of Discussion	20%	Some clarity issues; lacks logical flow in parts of the discussion.	Mostly clear; some minor ambiguities present.	Clear and coherent presentation of discussion; logical flow of ideas.
Integration with Literature	10%	Limited integration; few connections made with previous research.	Generally integrates literature; may miss some key connections.	Effectively integrates findings with existing literature, highlighting similarities, differences, and contributions.
Implications of Findings	10%	Basic discussion of implications; limited depth.	Addresses implications, but may lack depth in some areas.	Thoughtful discussion of practical, theoretical, and future research implications of findings.
Acknowledgment of Limitations	10%	Some mention of limitations; lacks detail and depth.	Addresses limitations but lacks depth in analysis.	Comprehensive discussion of limitations and their potential impact on the findings.
Writing Quality	10%	Some clarity issues; several errors affect readability.	Mostly clear writing; few errors.	Clear, concise, and error-free writing.

7 In-Class Presentation

Assigned: April 21.

Due: April 28 at 11:59pm. You will present as early as April 30, and as late as May 7.

Submission: Share a direct link to your repo / folder on canvas.nau.edu by the deadline. You may continue to revise this assignment until presentation day. Your presentation must be shared as a pdf, with all builds present (a new slide for each animation).

Points: This is worth 5% of your final grade, for all students.

Background:

Oral lectures serve as a fundamental component in the academic environment, providing a dynamic platform for knowledge transfer between educators and students. They foster an interactive learning atmosphere where complex concepts can be conveyed in an engaging and accessible manner. Through verbal communication, lecturers can elucidate intricate ideas, emphasize key points, and illustrate examples in a way that written materials alone may not achieve. Additionally, oral presentations allow for immediate feedback and clarification, enabling students to ask questions and engage in discussions that deepen understanding. The tonal nuances, body language, and passionate delivery of an instructor can significantly enhance the educational experience, making information more relatable and memorable. Overall, oral lectures cultivate critical thinking, encourage participation, and help build a collaborative learning community that enriches the academic journey.

Assignment:

Prepare a short presentation that covers all aspects of your project (everything you have written about, and all that is relevant that you skipped there). This should be structured in a slide deck (Google Slides, PowerPoint, Keynote, or Beamer $\text{\LaTeX}$ are all acceptable).

Expectations and Grading Rubric:

I expect your report to be complete, on the order of 3-5 pages. All citations should be in IEEE format, and you need at least two describing how your primary commodity is used in a research setting. Your submission should be single spaced, and a normal font size.

Area	Frac. of Points	UG: Meets Expectations	UG:Exceeds, G:Meets Expectations	G:Exceeds Expectations
Content Knowledge	20%	Basic understanding of the topic; struggles to answer questions adequately.	Shows good understanding; answers most questions correctly but may lack depth.	Demonstrates thorough understanding of the topic; answers questions confidently and accurately.
Organization	10%	Some organization; lacks clear transitions and logical flow.	Generally organized; some transitions may be unclear or missing.	Presentation is well-structured, with a clear introduction, body, and conclusion; ideas flow logically.
Engagement and Delivery	10%	Basic delivery; limited engagement with the audience; may read from notes.	Good delivery; maintains some eye contact and engages the audience, but may lack energy.	Highly engaging delivery; excellent eye contact, gestures, and vocal variety; captures audience interest.
Visual Aids	10%	Visual aids are basic; may not effectively support the presentation.	Visual aids are mostly clear and relevant but may lack some effectiveness.	Visual aids are clear, informative, and enhance the presentation; well-designed and relevant.
Timing	10%	May exceed or fall short of time limits; misses some key points.	Mostly stays within time limits; covers most key points but may rush in some areas.	Effectively manages time; covers all key points within the allotted 15 minutes.
Q&A Participation	15%	Limited participation in Q&A; responses may lack depth or clarity.	Responds to questions; may not fully engage with the audience in Q&A.	Encourages audience questions; responds fully and thoughtfully; demonstrates strong engagement.